

CMSC320 Introduction to Data Science

Writing Assignment 2

Read the Paper “Randomized Placebo-Controlled Placebo Trial to Determine the Placebo Effect Size”

(<https://www.painphysicianjournal.com/current/pdf?article=NDUwNA%3D%3D&journal=106>) and address the following questions:

1. What are the main parts of the paper?
2. Summarize the experimental design using words like control, treatment, hypothesis and sample.
3. What are the study's key findings, and how do they contribute to the current understanding of placebo effects in clinical trials? Are the results generalizable to all clinical trials?
4. What questions do you have for the authors of the study, or what criticisms?
5. If you were tasked with designing an experiment for a placebo-controlled study to further our understanding of the placebo effect, how may you design your study having learned, and being able to build on, this one? Assume you have a large but not unlimited budget.
6. How does it feel to read this research paper? Is that connected to how often you read research papers? How did you approach reading this one to make the most of it?
7. If you were to present the main findings to a wide college-educated audience, how might you format your presentation (e.g. as an article, a video etc.) to better reach your audience?

Tip: For each question, write at least 1 paragraph and no more than 2. Treat this as an opportunity to reflect and share your thoughts. You will be graded on **effort**, but **leniently**.

Submission Instructions: Submit a **pdf** file to Canvas.

Name the file as follows: 'CMSC320_WA2_YourName.pdf'

REMEMBER: The use of AI tools in generating responses is not allowed.